

KF7 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

We are exploring the **Maranatha Meditation** taught by John Main, OSB.¹ You can search the web for his work and history. He writes:

The all-important aim in Christian meditation is to allow God’s mysterious and silent presence within us to become more and more not only *a* reality, but *the* reality which gives meaning, shape and purpose to everything we do, to everything we are.²

We begin this meditation by sitting upright and as still as we can. If you are ill, fatigued, or holding a baby, sit propped up with pillows. You might like to sit up as if you were waiting for someone or something that is just around the corner. Breathe as you lightly close your eyes. (*Pause for 10 seconds*)

Continue to breathe while I offer a little clarification. *Maranatha* is an Aramaic prayer from the Bible.³ It can be translated three ways: *Our Lord is coming! . . . Our Lord has come. . . . Come, O Lord!* Silently, within your own mind, slowly say the word MAA-RAA-NAA-THAA during the meditation time. Some members find it helpful to move their lips as they attend to the word. If your mind wanders, gently draw it back to the word. We will focus on *maranatha* for three minutes, and I will remind you of this word at the start of each minute. Let’s begin. MAA-RAA-NAA-THAA. (*Pause for 3 minutes, restating the word at the beginning of each minute*)

Now pause. Take a few deep breaths and open your eyes. Gently bring your mind back to the meeting. John Main recommends that we meditate for twenty to thirty minutes twice each day.

Our hymn and prayer is *Teach Me Thy Way, O Lord*, by Benjamin R. Ramsey.

Teach me Thy way, O Lord, teach me Thy way!
Thy guiding grace afford, teach me Thy way!
Help me to walk aright, more by faith, less by sight;
Lead me with heavenly light, teach me Thy way!⁴

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

This month we are considering KF Confession 2:

We abandoned the glory that was ours, designed for us by our Creator.

For this meeting, you might want to have your **Two Paths Flowchart** handy.

Our only hope of recovery is in Jesus. He gives us an alternative to worshipping our fears and obeying our compulsions. It is His resurrection, His example, and His love that empower us to courageously learn to be people of no fear. To follow Christ's example, we must learn to love. There is no other way to follow Him. Thankfully, we have the Bible, the Holy Spirit, and a community of fellow believers to help us heal and teach us how to love.

Let's review some of our KF tools.

1. The Meeting Preparation Guide

Someone pointed out that the **Meeting Preparation Guide** is like a progress chart that measures how far we have come and how much we still need to grow. That's one reason why the guide is so valuable. As you fill out the guide, you learn to tell your real story, and you may experience more peace because you are getting in touch with reality. The guide helps you celebrate your progress and admit where you need more training. Sharing what you learn about yourself is a confession to God and to the group. Genuine confession strengthens the True Self. Be sure to keep your finished guides so that one day you can look back and see how far you have come.

2. Our manuals

The Bible and the book *Neurosis and Human Growth* are our manuals in KF, and you are always welcome to call in to the NHG book studies when KF offers them.⁵ The group discussion enriches our understanding and rekindles our commitment to recovering the True Self. We can sometimes see how much of our True Self we have recovered when we listen to others who are confronting their Idol Self for the first time. We encourage them, and they encourage us. When you read your Bible, as I hope you do, consider how what you are reading brings into spiritual perspective Dr. Horney's description of our battle with neurosis.

I would like to encourage those of you who may feel that Bible reading is a burden, or even loathsome. Many of us have had toxic experiences with the Bible and may carry trauma because of the way that we were taught. This is a great time to feel some compassion for yourself. Use your KF tools and allow yourself some space to heal. Just read the KF Bible teachings if that is more comfortable. You may need to invest in your True Self for a while before you can tackle this area of trauma. Other members have found that their KF work has rekindled an interest in their True Self and design and, also, in God and what He has to say to them through the Bible.

3. Mindfulness and meditation practice

We are now learning the **Maranatha Meditation**, but you also have the **3-Minute Breathing Space** in your toolbox.⁶

Mindfulness practice trains you to wait attentively before the Lord. It can also calm you down in the moment and make that moment much less difficult. Our moments are often filled with stress, impatience, discontent, and anxiety. We can use mindfulness to simply be—to experience what is, to enjoy what can be enjoyed, and to learn to endure without judgment. In a place of non-judgment, our mind and spirit have more freedom to be creative and connect to God.

4. Worksheets and guides

Tools like the list **Love or Pride?** help us to untangle our reactions and recognize the underlying fear. You will find all the worksheets and guides on the website under **Toolbox**. Feel free to explore these by yourself or with your Karis Link.

5. The Tapping Protocol⁷

We introduced tapping a couple of weeks ago. If you would like to see a video demonstration, go to [Alison's tapping and TAT videos](#) on YouTube. The **Tapping Protocol** script can be found on the KF website under the **Toolbox** tab.

Tapping is a simple means of calming our bodies and defusing its stored reactions to trauma. Most of us have been taught to abuse our bodies as if they were galley slaves that should be maltreated with whips and neglect. Perhaps you have never learned that, just like your mind, your body needs to process events. Your body is not a galley slave that can be thrown overboard if it does not perform to your standards. Your body is the ship, and if the ship goes down, you go down with it. In KF, we learn to care for our bodies and enter into partnership with them so that we can express the glory of God in this created world. If we care for our bodies, our bodies will care for us. Tapping is one way to take care of our bodies.

6. The Two Paths Flowchart

This tool helps you confront the secret life of your Idol—a secret life of continual anxiety, judgments, hurt, and storytelling, all of which lead to chaotic outcomes. You can use the flowchart to trace these outcomes back to their beginnings and then to explore how you might redirect your precious energy toward healthier outcomes.

Take out your **Two Paths Flowchart**. I hope that you have added a printed copy to your KF ring binder.

This flowchart starts with an event. Events happen to everyone all the time. Events are those experiments that we have been talking about. Some events feel good, and some feel bad, but that doesn't mean that the events *are* good or bad. It only means that we have feelings about them. Perhaps you have now learned that your feelings are untrustworthy guides for judging good and evil.

The Idol Self is driven by fear, and it reacts with judgment. When we are surrounded by various experiences and common life events that threaten our search for glory, our Idol Self reacts by blaming our circumstances or other people; it is unwilling to give up its illusions about what it deserves or how life should be. The True Self, on the other hand, recognizes that life is full of all kinds of events and knows that, with training and with God, it is fully capable of successfully handling whatever comes. It is only through our cooperation with the love of God residing in the True Self that we can successfully navigate life's events.

Try not to be discouraged at this point if you find yourself living on the lower path of judgment. I haven't met a single person who, seeing this flowchart for the first time, has said, "Isn't it marvelous? I am consistently living on the upper path!" We live on the lower path for understandable reasons. In the coming weeks, you will learn how to begin moving from the lower path, which is the path of constant judgments and fear, to the upper path, which is the path of mindful observation and love. You will learn how to move from your sinking ship to a ship that floats.

Remember that you cannot use all of the KF tools all of the time. Schedule your own KF training time this week and take one of the following small steps toward your liberty and potential:

1. Read again or listen to the introduction and first chapter of *Neurosis and Human Growth*.⁸ Listening to a book can expand our understanding of the material, and you might explore that option using a program like *Audible*.⁹
2. Review the chapters in the book that describe your neurotic solution, and you might read chapters 12–16. Begin making a short list of the kinds of events that are likely to send you down the judgment path.
3. Use your **Meeting Preparation Guide** to record events and your reactions to those events. You might review what you have written on your earlier guides and see how far you have already come.
4. Schedule time to read the **Expanded Version** of the teaching notes or email KF admin and ask for the **KF Compass**, which regularly delivers portions of the **Expanded Version** to your email.
5. Practice one of your tools. You might tap or, perhaps, review an event using the flowchart.

Remember, any effort toward investing in your True Self is success. Let me say that again: any effort is success. Just showing up for your meeting is success. You are not looking for perfection. You are looking for slow, small, but steady progress.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord, show me where to take time to practice my KF training. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

Let's continue to explore KF Confession 2:

We abandoned the glory that was ours, designed for us by our Creator.

I hope that you have a Bible or your copy of the letter from James in front of you while we look at the subject of endurance. A successful workout for your body challenges your physical endurance. KF training is a workout that challenges the courage and endurance of your mind and soul. When you find yourself in

a time of endurance, you often feel fear, which can present itself as frustration or anger. Courage is the ability to endure that fear while you make oriented choices. Your times of mindful endurance then become productive because whenever you endure your fear, you grow your courage, and this leads to more oriented outcomes. Courage is like a muscle; it is strengthened through exercising endurance in challenging situations. Developed courage is essential if you are to become a person of no fear. Here are two points that we might keep in mind.

1. Endurance requires long-tempered love

Endurance is not forever even though it may feel like it at times. We need endurance when we are in situations that examine our commitment, our trust, and our trustworthiness. Last week, we learned about love being long-tempered rather than short-tempered. We are growing into long-tempered endurance that can resist compulsive reactions to those uncomfortable and revealing events—those life experiments, those days of judgment or examination. Your KF training empowers you; you no longer find yourself without choices. Instead of giving in to the dictates of your fear, you can choose to endure your discomforts productively and respond with love and orientation.

Different experiments and situations will call for different kinds of endurance. Just like any test of our physical endurance, life events will test our mental, emotional, and spiritual endurance. Whether short-term or long-term, we can choose to disengage from our experiment with endurance, or we can choose to continue our experiment in order to strengthen our ability to endure. Here are some examples of short-term endurance: standing in a line at a store, surviving the flu, calming a fussy child. Long-term endurance strengthens our ability to stay focused and productive even when we cannot see an end to our struggle. A difficult marriage, a job, a conflict, an education, an illness, a child, a debt, avoiding addictive behaviors and, most importantly, the restoration of our True Self are all examples of situations that will require long-term and courageous endurance. Without that kind of endurance, you will never discover what is gloriously possible for your life. In Karis Fellowships, we train to endure the compelling need to save our Idol's life. We learn to seek creative solutions to our problems rather than abdicating our lives to the dictates of fear. When we engage in this training, we strengthen our ability to endure, and, step by step, we reclaim our original design and become creatures with authority and dominion who can co-labor with God in this material world.

2. People differ in what they must learn to endure

Always remember with compassion that people differ in what they find hard to endure. What requires dogged endurance for one Idol type may be easy for another. Our job is to help each other, but we are not called to help each other indefinitely. Some people need to find themselves without help in order to feel desperate enough to give up their idolatry and get into training. Not even God will continue to support us if we persistently hesitate and waver in our obedience to Him and consistently choose the path of our Idol Self.

Let's return to our study of the letter from James. This is my translation of **James 1:5–8**.

⁵But if anyone should find themselves lacking practical skill in situations, let them ask God about it. God generously gives practical help to everyone, and He gives without throwing their dysfunction back in their faces to shame and belittle them. God will give wisdom to the one who asks for skill to deal with situations, ⁶but that person must ask in faith. In other words, they must be ready to act upon what God shows them, without any hesitancy or wavering; for the one who wavers is like the surf of the sea, driven and tossed

by the wind.⁷ Such persons ought not to imagine that they will receive anything from the Lord,⁸ being double-minded, or of two spirits, and, therefore, unstable in all their ways. Take a deep breath.

1. Double-minded people cannot receive guidance from God

We see in this passage that God is willing to give to everyone the wisdom they need to become accomplished, integrated, and fully equipped. He knows that learning wisdom is a process that requires training and takes time. He is not going to reproach us or chide us for not being fully developed in our wisdom at this moment. The Idol and self-hate do that.

Each time you fall into a trial or an experiment, you discover areas where you need wisdom. Discovering these areas is essential for your growth. God is always willing to teach you, but you forfeit the benefit of His guidance by being double-minded and holding open the option to judge according to your own understanding. If you want to explore the top path of the flowchart, the path of love, and yet, at the same time, you keep the lower path of judgment in your pocket as insurance, you will be tossed around and make no progress. While you continue to consider active misorientation as an option, you will regularly default to the path of judgment. This is the easiest path, and by constant capitulation you become habituated to giving in to your compelling tensions. As a consequence, you never move forward; you simply reinforce old habits. If you find yourself continually changing your mind or choosing misorientation, it means that you are, as yet, without conviction. Either you need more training and healing, or you need a more thorough commitment.

Every kingdom divided against itself will fall.¹⁰ When you are acting out of neurosis, you are a divided kingdom. You vacillate between your allegiance to the Idol and your allegiance to love. You are not yet willing to take responsibility for how you perpetuate your suffering through our own choices and reactions. When your commitment wavers and is unstable, the Lord really cannot guide you to wisdom. If He helps you while you are still committed to saving your Idol's life and taking the lower path of judgment, you will continue to think that the judgment path works. If He doesn't help you, you blame Him and everyone else for abandoning you to the unhealthy consequences of your own chaos and misorientation. Your house is built upon sand.¹¹ God would love to help you, but your pride stands in His way.

If you are double-minded, you will tell yourself that you follow the Bible as a guide, and yet in reality you choose to do your own thing. But if you are single-minded, you will regularly choose to get into training. You will get help. You will stay connected to your True Self, to the community, and to God. You will choose to become a doer of what you are taught, not just a hearer. It is only by doing that you actually learn how to live by God's guidance and build a healthier and more oriented life—what Jesus called “a house built on the rock”.¹² That is a life that declares the glory of God.

2. We have a choice as to how we will live

When we commit to learning how to live on the upper path of the Two Paths Flowchart, our lives really do become more peaceful, more loving, and more authentic. We also find that we have more self-control. But none of this happens overnight, and we need constant support while we are learning courage and endurance. That's why we keep asking God and the community to teach us wisdom and practical skill. Just as we have been trained to default to the path of judgment, we can retrain ourselves, under the guidance of the Holy Spirit, to choose the path of love. You really can do it. The Bible says you can, and empirical research says you can.

Our second Bible reading for this lesson is **Proverbs 3:5–7**. You might look at this passage in the context of the whole chapter, which offers encouragement and all kinds of promises to those who choose to become single-minded and learn wisdom. Here is my version of this text:

⁵Make sure that all your motivation begins with trust in God. Do not lean on your own understanding. ⁶In all your choices be mindful of Him and He will straighten your path toward oriented outcomes. ⁷Do not be wise in your own estimation; fear God and turn away from doing damage.

Take a deep breath.

If you regularly find yourself choosing the lower path, keep this passage in mind. You might copy and post these verses where you will often see them. That may help you remember to stop giving in to fear.

The quality of your relationship with God is the result of your choices. If you choose to lean on your own understanding, being wise in your own estimation and doing things your own way, you will stay on the lower path of the flowchart and disconnect yourself from God. But if you are mindful of what God values and honor His way of doing things, you will remain on the upper path and will learn to trust God with all your heart. Your greatest experiment in this world is to choose to live your life God's way and see what happens. I'm sorry to say that when you become a Christian, the boss is no longer you! Fear God by obeying Him as the Boss. Let Him make your path straight. Choose today whom you will serve.¹³ You really do have a choice. Trusting in God's way of doing things is how godly choices are made.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord, in one area of my life this week, remind me to acknowledge You as the Boss and trust Your way of doing things. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider a situation in which you want, so badly, to lean on your own understanding. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

(Choose from each section a few sentences that are meaningful for you)

Feelings

As you *consider a situation in which you want, so badly, to lean on your own understanding*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. We often flush thoughts and feelings from our awareness before they have a chance to teach us. Breathe, and hold them up to the light. Observe whatever you may be experiencing as you *consider a situation in which you want, so badly, to lean on your own understanding.* (Pause) Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Breathe, and bring your attention to your body. Notice what it is doing when you *consider this situation in which you want, so badly, to lean on your own understanding.* What sensations are there? (Pause) Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what craving, anger, or anxiety feels like in your body. (Pause) If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this situation in which you want, so badly, to lean on your own understanding.* Do you feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or are you shutting down? Just observe. (Pause) Do you tend to judge this situation as good or evil? (Pause) Is this judgment a regular pattern in your life? What story do you want to tell? (Pause) Are you afraid of something—of loss, of hurt, of others, or of yourself? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Heal

God created us to have all of these feelings, and for thousands of years human beings have been feeling like you do when they have wanted, so badly, to lean on their own understanding. You are not alone in your feelings. You are a human creature. (Pause) You might remember that feelings are just chemical reactions in your body bringing you information. With training, you can choose what you will do with that information. (Pause) When a fear or judgment signals you through the body, you can focus on your body and your breath rather than getting caught up in a story and reacting. Breathe with compassion for yourself and for all those who long to lean on their own understanding. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?”)

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to the truth about our faith in You. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?”)

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

¹ John Main, *Monastery without Walls: The Spiritual Letters of John Main*, ed. Laurence Freeman (London: Canterbury Press Norwich, 2006), 32.

² John Main, *Silence and Stillness in Every Season: Daily Readings with John Main*, ed. Paul Harris (New York: Continuum International Publishing Group, 1997), 2.

³ 1 Cor. 16:22; Rev. 22:20.

⁴ *Teach Me Thy Way, O Lord* by Benjamin Mansell Ramsey (1849–1923), youtu.be/FmY6848ZQeo.

⁵ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁶ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G. Williams and John D. Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁷ Dr. Roger Callahan, “TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping,” Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁸ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁹ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle toward Self-Realization*, read by Heather Henderson (Ashland: Blackstone Audio, 2011), audiobook, 15 hours, 43 minutes, www.audible.com/pd/Science-Technology/Neurosis-and-Human-Growth-Audiobook.

¹⁰ Mark 3:34.

¹¹ Mark 7:26.

¹² Matt. 7:24.

¹³ Josh. 24:15.